

Delaware County MUST Meeting - September 1st, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-vTi4_l8aVs
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Municipal Meeting Report

Delaware County Municipal Unit Strategic Task Force

Meeting Date: September (Year not explicitly stated, references 2025/2026/2028/2030)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript indicates that an initial pre-planning and educational session was held previously on August 18th (with [HH:MM:SS] not formally timestamped to a separate pre-meeting hearing block, but summarized during the main meeting). - **Session Type & Topic:** Pre-planning and educational session reviewing the current 1.5% Local Income Tax (LIT) structure (expiring at the end of 2028) and the new structure created by Senate Enrolled Act 1 (SEA 1) of 2025 and House Enrolled Act 1210 (HEA 1210) of 2026, which takes effect in 2030. - **Summary of Discussion:** Paige Sansen (Baker Tilly) and Sam Vandervine (Policy Analytics) walked the task force through how distribution shifts from a levy-based model to a largely population-based model. Only Muncie and Yorktown meet the 3,500 population threshold to set their own municipal rates. Policy Analytics built a distribution model presenting four revenue-neutral scenarios based on whether Muncie and Yorktown opt in or opt out.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:10:47 Presiding officer Matt Can convenes the first official meeting of the Delaware County Municipal Unit Strategic Task Force, noting it is convened under Indiana Code § 6-3.6-3-13 following LIT restructuring under SEA 1 (2025) and HEA 1210 (2026). Meetings are open to the public, livestreamed, and recorded under Indiana's Open Door Law.
 - **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Matt Can (Delaware County Council / Presiding Officer), Matt Wagley (City of Muncie), Lance Turner (Yorktown), Joyce Hamilton (Albany), Bridget Dise (Eaton), Jennifer Divine (Selma), Tracy Pittinger (Gaston).
 - **Members Absent:** Amy Roberts (Daleville), Deborah Dunham (Chesterfield).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:10:57 Opening remarks and a moment of silence held in memory of Craig Wright, who served as City Controller under Mayor Dan Ridenour's administration. 00:11:35 Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not addressed in this meeting transcript.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:15:49 Presentation and Review of Policy Analytics LIT Scenarios**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason O'Neal and Sam Vandervine (Policy Analytics).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of four model scenarios for local income tax distribution, designed around the cornerstone of **revenue neutrality** for the county, Muncie, Yorktown, small municipalities as a group, and non-municipal units (townships, libraries, airport, sanitary, and transportation).
 - **Baseline Assumptions:** Fire and EMS LIT revenue is allocated uniformly by decennial census population (approx. 85% Muncie, 15% Yorktown) at a maximum authorized rate of 0.40%.
 - **The Four Scenarios:**
 1. *Scenario 1:* Muncie and Yorktown both **opt in** to receive distributions of the small municipal LIT revenue. (Uniform countywide rate under 1.5%, approx. 1.38%).
 2. *Scenario 2:* Muncie and Yorktown both **opt out**, imposing their own large municipal rates.
 3. *Scenario 3:* Muncie **opts in**, Yorktown **opts out**.
 4. *Scenario 4:* Muncie **opts out**, Yorktown **opts in**.
 - **Key Findings / Complications:** The transition shifts from property tax levy-based to population-based. Because certain small units (e.g., Eaton, Daleville, Center Township) currently leverage higher relative distributions under the old

levy system, moving to population-based distribution creates localized funding reductions (winners and losers). Addressing these gaps would require creative solutions such as interlocal agreements, memoranda of agreement (MOAs) for revenue transfer, or shared service adjustments.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific presentation window.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal vote taken at this time.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:12:56 Mayor Dan Ridenour (City of Muncie)**
 - Stated that the City of Muncie will **not** be opting out. Scenarios 2 and 4 are non-starters for Muncie. Muncie will opt in (Scenario 1 or Scenario 3) to keep rates stable and keep entities whole.
- **01:13:32 Lance Turner (Town of Yorktown)**
 - Expressed agreement that opting in is the best path for Yorktown as well.
- **01:14:48 Bridget Dise (Town of Eaton)**
 - Highlighted that under the modeling, Eaton faces a significant funding reduction (approx. \$71,000 hit), which severely impacts their fire protection contract and police support allocations funded through the general fund. Requested working out alternative options or sharing agreements before finalizing a decision.
- **01:18:21 Bill Hughes (Muncie Firefighter / Public Commentator)**
 - Inquired whether the general shared county rate could be adjusted to make up losses for units experiencing deficits. County staff clarified that shared rates flow directly to the county, requiring legal review of contracts or MOAs to redistribute. Noted that rising operational costs (fire trucks, salaries) will compound future budget strains.
- **01:19:56 Bill Hughes (Delaware County Council Member)**
 - Suggested that when a final recommendation is adopted, tax rates should be rounded to one or two decimal places rather than four to ensure clarity for taxpayers.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **01:21:51 Next Meeting Date:** Rescheduled from Tuesday the 15th to **September 29th at 4:00 PM.**
 - Agenda will revisit Model 1, discuss potential gap-making adjustments for disadvantaged units, and look toward taking a formal vote/recommendation.

- **Adjournment:** Meeting concluded following scheduling announcements (exact timestamp/disposition of final gavel not explicitly recorded in text, but transitioned out following public comment).

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